

EXECUTIVE BRIEF

See Urban Change Without Inventing Tenure

What leaders should authorize, require, and refuse

Production Unit	PU-B07-C52
Decision status	Controlled learning asset
Audience	Executives, programme owners, statisticians, technical leads
Data	Synthetic examples only

Executive takeaway: Measure urban growth and land-use change without inferring legal tenure, ownership, occupancy rights, or enforcement status from imagery or classification alone.

Why it matters

Remote-sensing classifications can be misused to invent tenure claims, criminalize residents, or justify displacement without due process.

Illustrative application

A planning team confirms observed land-cover change with authorized records and field evidence before considering action.

Minimum approval conditions

- Named accountable owner and lawful purpose
- Defined evidence, provenance, reference period, population, and geography
- Decision-relevant validation and visible uncertainty
- Documented abstention, referral, override, and incident processes
- Accessibility, equity, security, retention, and retirement review

Non-negotiable boundary

The analytical system may inform review. It may not independently authorize benefits, sanctions, enforcement, clinical treatment, school exclusion, displacement, or another consequential action.